Essential IELTS Vocabulary

20 Common Phrases & Idioms for Speaking and Writing

Part 1: IELTS Speaking (Idioms & Natural Phrases)

Note: Idioms should strictly be used in IELTS Speaking to maintain a natural tone. Avoid them in formal writing.

Idiom / Phrase	Bangla Meaning	Example Usage
Once in a blue moon	খুব কদাচিৎ / খুব কম	I only eat fast food **once in a blue moon** because I try to maintain a healthy diet.
Over the moon	অত্যন্ত আনন্দিত	I was **over the moon** when I received my university acceptance letter.
Cost an arm and a leg	অনেক ব্যয়বহুল	Studying abroad can **cost an arm and a leg**, but it is worth the investment.
Piece of cake	অত্যন্ত সহজ কাজ	I thought the driving exam would be tough, but it turned out to be a **piece of cake**.
Burn the midnight oil	রাত জেগে কাজ/পড়া করা	I had to **burn the midnight oil** for two weeks straight to finish my final project.
Hit the nail on the head	একদম সঠিক কথা বলা	You **hit the nail on the head** when you said public transport needs more funding.
Out of the blue	অপ্রত্যাশিতভাবে / হঠাৎ	I hadn't heard from my school friend in years, and then she called me **out of the blue**.
Pass with flying colors	দারুণ সফলতা পাওয়া	She studied hard and **passed her language test with flying colors**.
Down to earth	বাস্তববাদী ও নম্র	My high school mentor was immensely successful yet completely **down to earth**.

Idiom / Phrase	Bangla Meaning	Example Usage
A blessing in disguise	ছদ্মবেশে পাওয়া বরদান	Missing the bus was **a blessing in disguise** because I avoided the traffic bottleneck.

Part 2: IELTS Writing (Academic Phrases)

Note: Formal academic phrases work best in IELTS Writing (Tasks 1 & 2) and Speaking Part 3.

Phrase / Collocation	Bangla Meaning	Example Usage
A double-edged sword	সুবিধা ও অসুবিধা উভয় থাকা বিষয়	Artificial intelligence is **a double-edged sword**; it boosts productivity but creates security risks.
Pave the way for	পথ সুগম করা	Advancements in renewable technology are **paving the way for** a greener economy.
Play a vital role in	গুরুত্বপূর্ণ ভূমিকা পালন করা	Quality primary education **plays a vital role in** reducing long-term poverty.
Take into consideration	বিবেচনায় নেওয়া	Policymakers must **take public opinion into consideration** before passing new traffic laws.
At an alarming rate	উদ্বেগজনক হারে	Deforestation is currently occurring **at an alarming rate** across tropical regions.
Bring to light	প্রকাশ বা উন্মোচন করা	Recent environmental reports have **brought to light** the severe impacts of microplastics.
A bone of contention	বিবাদের বিষয়	The allocation of government budgets remains **a major bone of contention** among local leaders.
On the flip side	অন্যদিকে (বিপরীত দৃষ্টিকোণ)	Remote employment offers flexibility; **on the flip side**, it can lead to professional isolation.
Food for thought	গভীরভাবে ভাবার মতো বিষয়	The documentary provided immense **food for thought** regarding global consumerism habits.

Phrase / Collocation	Bangla Meaning	Example Usage
Bridge the gap	ব্যবধান কমানো বা মেটানো	E-learning platforms can effectively **bridge the gap** between rural students and quality tuition.